



Inspection Report

Loyola University Chicago
2160 S. FIRST AVE.
BUILDING 115 ROOM 432-8
MAYWOOD, IL 60153

Customer ID: **583**
Certificate: **33-R-0024**
Site: 001
STITCH SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 30-JUN-2026

2.31(d)(1)(ii)

Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC).

The written narrative description of the methods and sources used to determine that alternatives were not available in Protocol #25-025 did not illustrate that the principal investigator considered alternatives to the aortic constriction procedure described in the protocol. This procedure causes more than momentary pain and/or distress. Proposals to conduct an animal activity must contain enough detail for the IACUC to determine that proposed activities or significant changes in ongoing activities meet all requirements as outlined in Part 2, Subpart C, Section 2.31(d). Details are to include the consideration of alternatives when there is a possibility of causing more than momentary or slight pain or distress to the animals, and a written narrative description of the methods and sources used to determine that alternatives were not available. The protocol did not contain all the needed information for the IACUC to properly assess if/how pain and distress could be limited to that which is unavoidable for the conduct of scientifically valuable research.

The IACUC shall determine that the principal investigator has both considered alternatives to procedures that may cause more than momentary or slight pain or distress to the animals and provided a written narrative description of the methods and sources used to determine that alternatives were not available.

Correct by August 17, 2026.

2.31(d)(7)

Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC).

On April 14, 2026, the IACUC voted to suspend "all aortic constriction surgeries" in Protocol #25-025. The Institutional Official, however, did not report the suspended protocol activity to APHIS or the Federal agency funding the activity along with a full explanation of the reasons for the suspension and the corrective action as required by this Section. Failure to report suspension actions to APHIS (and any other Federal agency funding that activity) prevents Federal oversight and tracking of animal welfare concerns.

The Institutional Official shall notify APHIS and any Federal agency funding that activity of the suspension along with a full explanation of the corrective actions to be taken.

Correct by July 17, 2026.

Prepared By: DAWN BARKSDALE
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Date:
09-JUL-2026

Received by Title: Attending Veterinarian

Date:
09-JUL-2026



Inspection Report

2.33(b)(1) Critical

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care.

The research facility did not have appropriate equipment to provide adequate veterinary care. According to IACUC records and to facility representatives, on March 25, 2026, three animals underwent aortic constriction surgery on Protocol #25-025; however, one of the animals (1416) did not recover after surgery, failing to breathe on their own after being taken off the ventilator. On March 26, 2026, three additional animals underwent aortic constriction surgery; however, two of the animals (1418, 1419) experienced respiratory distress resulting in the need for the animals to be humanely euthanized. The IACUC attributed the animal deaths to unreliable ventilator function during the surgical procedures.

Procedures performed on animals requiring ventilation must be conducted utilizing properly calibrated and maintained equipment.

Each research facility shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include availability of appropriate equipment, among other requirements, to comply with the provisions of this subchapter.

Correct prior to procedures requiring use of a ventilator.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with facility representatives.

Prepared By: DAWN BARKSDALE
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Date:
09-JUL-2026

Received by Title: Attending Veterinarian

Date:
09-JUL-2026



Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
583	33-R-0024	001	STRITCH SCHOOL OF MEDICINE	30-JUN-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000006	<i>Cavia porcellus</i>	DOMESTIC GUINEA PIG
000006	Total	